

Objective proof that AI does not use a ton of water or energy

Posted by u/Frequent_Research_94 • • 0 points • 64 comments

I can use an image generator on my phone locally with a 5000mAh battery (standard). The percentage does not go down by a percent, the smallest amount it shows, when I do this.

Also, no water is used.

Yes, I know the battery % is an estimate, but it is pretty precise, and definitely not more than 2x off.

Comments

u/princesscaos • 0 points • 2025-06-17 21:57 UTC

I think this is the best part of the article

"Let's say you're running a marathon as a charity runner and organizing a fundraiser to support your cause. You ask an AI model 15 questions about the best way to fundraise.

Then you make 10 attempts at an image for your flyer before you get one you are happy with, and three attempts at a five-second video to post on Instagram. You'd use about 2.9 kilowatt-hours of electricity—enough to ride over 100 miles on an e-bike (or around 10 miles in the average electric vehicle) or run the microwave for over three and a half hours."

Data centers can't rely on intermittent technologies like wind and solar power, and on average, they tend to use dirtier electricity.

"In February the AI research firm Epoch AI published an estimate of how much energy is used for a single ChatGPT query—an estimate that, as discussed, makes lots of assumptions that can't be verified. Still, they calculated about 0.3 watt-hours, or 1,080 joules, per message. This falls in between our estimates for the smallest and largest Meta Llama models (and experts we consulted say that if anything, the real number is likely higher, not lower). One billion of these every day for a year would mean over 109 gigawatt-hours of electricity, enough to power 10,400 US homes for a year. If we add images and imagine that generating each one requires as much energy as it does with our high-quality image models, it'd mean an additional 35 gigawatt-hours, enough to power another 3,300 homes for a year. This is on top of the energy demands of OpenAI's other products, like video generators, and that for all the other AI companies and startups."

this is where we are now! Not thinking about the ways AI could and will be used in the future

<https://www.technologyreview.com/2025/05/20/1116327/ai-energy-usage-climate-footprint-big-tech/>

Source

u/Frequent_Research_94 • 1 points • 2025-06-18 13:08 UTC

I think Andy Masley does a good job of pointing out the issue with this article:

[https://substack.com/@andymasley/note/c-118956479?](https://substack.com/@andymasley/note/c-118956479?r=21aet3&utm_medium=ios&utm_source=notes-share-action)

[r=21aet3&utm_medium=ios&utm_source=notes-share-action](https://substack.com/@andymasley/note/c-118956479?r=21aet3&utm_medium=ios&utm_source=notes-share-action)

u/princesscaos • 0 points • 2025-06-17 21:41 UTC

<https://www.technologyreview.com/2025/05/20/1116327/ai-energy-usage-climate-footprint-big-tech/>

I am kind of pro AI but the impact it has on the environment is undeniable. I understand that you used your phone on airplane mode but as many others have pointed out it is hugely about the data centers. it's not about your phone right now but about the resources and energy that it took to get to this point. I am pretty sure the world renowned MIT and it's editorial team are a reliable source. hope this helps

u/Frequent_Research_94 • 1 points • 2025-06-18 13:11 UTC

I don't actually think the MIT technology review is reliable for environmental pieces. I do read their magazine in full, and they ABSOLUTELY would make an article arguing that e-bikes are immoral as they use a minor amount of electricity.

u/Jealous-Associate-41 • -3 points • 2025-05-15 17:35 UTC

You're conflating local UI rendering with the actual model inference. That image generator you're using on your phone? It's not running a full diffusion model locally. It's sending a request to a server, likely a massive GPU cluster, where the real compute and energy use happen. Your phone is just the front end, like using a remote control and thinking you're powering the whole TV station.

Also, while your phone doesn't use water, the data centers running those models do, indirectly but significantly, for cooling. AI workloads can consume millions of liters of water per year per facility. So yeah, you're not just wrong, you're confidently misunderstanding every part of how this tech functions.

Im pro-ai

u/3personal5me • 1 points • 2025-05-16 12:02 UTC

He clearly said it's in airplane mode. Good job reading half a post and thinking you understood it

u/ResidentOwn6783 • 2 points • 2025-05-15 23:19 UTC

"Im pro-ai"

Lists anti-ai talking points.

/hj

u/Jealous-Associate-41 • 2 points • 2025-05-15 23:23 UTC

When the antis collectively become Amish, they might have a point.

u/Frequent_Research_94 • 3 points • 2025-05-15 18:29 UTC

The phone is in airplane mode

u/Different-Tune-3541 • 1 points • 2025-05-15 11:30 UTC

It's the training part that costs a lot of energy. Using it isn't that energy-intensive